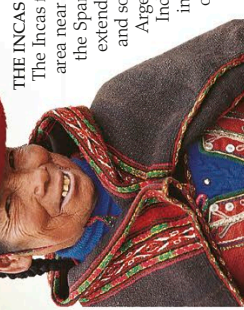


ANGEL FALLS
Each year thousands of tourists visit the spectacular Angel Falls on the River Churún in eastern Venezuela. The Falls were spotted by an American pilot, Jimmy Angel, in 1935, and later named after him. The water drops for 2,648 ft (807 m), making Angel Falls the highest uninterrupted waterfall in the world.

The railway from Lima climbs 15,807 ft (4,818 m) into the Andes and is the highest in the Americas.



Quechua woman in Peru

LIFE ON THE HIGH PLAINS

The Altiplano is a cold plateau at high altitude between two ranges of the Andes Mountains in southwest Bolivia and southern Peru. The native peoples who live here graze sheep and llamas on the windy plains. They have generally retained their own language and customs.



MINERALS

Many countries in this area have extensive reserves of gold, silver, copper, and gems. Colombia produces more than half the world's emeralds. The Incas made good use of these resources and created many beautiful golden objects, such as this llama.

LAKE TITICACA

At 12,507 ft (3,812 m), Lake Titicaca is the highest navigable lake in the world. It is also South America's largest lake. The Uru people live here in houses built on huge, floating reed islands. They grow potatoes, hunt birds, and catch fish, using boats made from tightly bundled reeds.



MACHU PICCHU

The conquering Spaniards never found the remains of this important Inca city—it remained a secret until Hiram Bingham, an American archaeologist and explorer, discovered its ruins hidden in the forest in 1911. Situated on a high ridge northwest of Cusco, this magnificent ruined city covers 5 sq miles (13 sq km), and has small houses, temples, and stairways built around a central square.

